



## MONTHLY UPDATE

# Gabon: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-06 · 23 systems and instruments tracked, 28 of them not held

*Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-06 – July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.*

## Summary of the month

The month's largest event was the entry into service of the Nkok data centre on 3 July 2026, and its largest set of commitments was the open-innovation programme launched on 14 July with two accords attached. A satellite seminar closed on 27 July with eleven recommendations, the unified social register produced its first deliverable on 29 July, and the regional QR-code payment standard entered force on 29 July with the Gabonese scheme as its pilot.

## Infrastructure

The Nkok facility was inaugurated on 3 July 2026 with 92 racks over 3,000 square metres, 1 MW installed and a cost of XAF 8bn, peered to the ACE and SAT-3/WACS submarine systems, with about 22 per cent of site energy from a photovoltaic plant and water-free cooling ([figures given at the inauguration](#)). The operator stated at the same event that about 95 per cent of data produced in Gabon was hosted outside the country.

On 27 July the Libreville seminar on space communications closed with eleven recommendations, confirming a hybrid fibre and satellite model on 2,000 km of fibre already deployed and calling for an autonomous national satellite system and sub-regional agreement for it to operate ([close of the seminar](#)).

On 31 July the minister inspected the second Tier III facility, a neutral carrier hotel built by the state company ACE Gabon SA at 160 racks and over 1 MW, interconnected to the submarine systems, and confirmed commissioning between end-November and early December 2026; he described it as a public structure financed by the local banking sector ([site inspection](#)). No cost figure was given.

The national internet exchange point opened a reboot workshop at Libreville on 3 August, running to 8 August, with the Internet Society and AFRINIC as technical partners ([opening](#)).

## Digital public infrastructure

The regional interoperable QR-code standard was launched at Douala on 29 July 2026 under the monetary union regulation of 8 April 2026, in force across all six member states and settled through the regional switch, with the Gabonese scheme as its pilot ([launch](#)). The switch's 2025 figures, presented the following day, were 20.3m

transactions worth FCFA 863bn across 153 participants ([figures](#)). On 9 July the central bank acceded to the pan-African payment and settlement system, with member-state banks to be connected by the end of 2026 ([announcement](#)).

Domestic acceptance figures published on 30 July put banks at 457,377 cardholders among 673,793 clients, against 326 cash machines and 1,535 merchant terminals; of 1,101,434 transactions in June, 62.41 per cent were cash withdrawals and 24.61 per cent terminal payments ([bank association](#)).

On 21 July an interministerial committee fixed the terms of a second census of economically weak Gabonese, with preparation through July and August and fieldwork from September 2026, drawing on the population census and health-insurance records; its stated purpose is that the existing social file is not reliable enough to target protection ([terms](#)). On 30 July the education ministry received 1,000 tablets for what the minister described as 148 connected schools ([handover](#)). On 2 August the border agency's tourist electronic visa platform, developed in 2025, was presented to the travel trade ([account](#)).

## Governance and regulation

On 11 July nine civil-society organisations declared the broadcasting authority's social-media suspension unconstitutional, disproportionate and beyond its statutory remit, and demanded its abrogation; they also stated that a bill regulating social media exists and awaits promulgation ([declaration](#)). On 17 July the presidential spokesman defended the measure as temporary and conservatory and gave no lifting date. On 25 July an advocacy association presented a report built from two months of consultations, finding no transparent mechanism governing restriction of social networks and recommending revision of the ordinance of 8 April 2026 and greater independence for the broadcasting authority ([report](#)).

On 23 July a national workshop validated by consensus five implementing texts on the digitalisation of teaching — two decrees, two orders and a decree creating a basic computing certificate — and forwarded them to the competent authorities with recommendations. They are technically validated and not adopted ([close of the workshop](#)).

On 31 July the ministry's final technical committee of the administrative year named its next-cycle workstreams, among them a candidacy for International Telecommunication Union governance bodies, with no body, seat or election date named ([review](#)).

## Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

The open-innovation programme was launched on 14 July 2026 with the employers' federation, addressing a population the organisers put at 150 to 200 start-ups, with pre-selection on 24 July and a final on 4 August ([launch](#)). Two accords were signed on the margins the same day: one with the state guarantee company to put in place guarantee mechanisms reducing the risk borne by institutions lending to innovative young firms, and one with an equipment supplier to create smart rooms, deliver training in networks, cybersecurity, artificial intelligence and software development, and supply its certifying training kits ([account of both accords](#)). Neither accord's terms were published — no ceiling, coverage ratio, eligibility test, room count, trainee target, cost or duration — and no laureate list has followed the final.

On 4 July, at the data-centre inauguration, the ministry and the facility's operator signed a memorandum giving ministry-supported start-ups professional hosting at preferential rates ([account](#)). No rate, eligibility list or take-up figure has been published.

## Inclusion, capacity and finance

On 14 July the state guarantee company signed the credit-guarantee accord described above; it is the first instrument in the base addressed to the cost of capital for Gabonese digital firms, and it carries no envelope ([account](#)).

On 23 July the validated implementing texts included a draft decree creating a basic computing and internet certificate for education, with no syllabus, awarding body, cohort target or start date attached ([workshop close](#)).

On 29 July the social affairs ministry presented the first deliverable of the unified social register at Libreville, with World Bank representatives present, alongside a stated commitment to full digitalisation of non-contributory social protection under the 2026-2030 development plan ([presentation](#)). No beneficiary count, coverage figure or platform was given, and the state's own account uses three different names for the register in the same document.

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